

cleaning in and around the toilet, but for other less germy jobs, old rags are the perfect reusable alternative.

My favorite way to make our own rags is to cut up old t-shirts, towels, and blankets, and store them neatly folded on a shelf in my laundry room. I use these for dusting, wiping up spills, and as floor, tub, and sink rags as needed. Then I just throw them in the wash when I'm finished.

For kitchen counters and wiping down table crumbs, I have a few store bought dishcloths, but I also recommend homemade crocheted or knitted cloths as well. At first, I was really afraid to use them (I didn't want to ruin all the hard work put in!), but I actually like the way they clean much better than the store-bought brands. You can find easy dishcloth tutorials online, or buy a book on Amazon and learn how to make your own. I love keeping my hands busy knitting while I'm watching one of my favorite TV shows.

READER TIP:

I used to make my own all-purpose cleaner (countertops, windows, etc.) but now I only use Norwex cloths—these are antibacterial cloths that just use water, and cut down on paper towels as well as chemical cleaning supplies. They are amazing and I was super skeptical about them at first. My mom sent me some to try and now I'm hooked!

—Elizabeth, PA

4. DON'T FALL PREY TO RETAIL MARKETING

One of the things I mentioned at the beginning of this chapter was how easy it is to fall prey to pretty packaging and sleazy marketing. As brands release more and more cleaning products for you to buy, and for very specific tasks, you feel compelled to try them in an effort to see if they would work a lot better than the products you already have. At least that's how I always feel!

But a good cleaner can do wonders for sinks, tubs, toilets, floors, cabinets, and much more. It just might take a little trial and error to find your